



You don't need to set up a data centre to host a Web site. Even a company Web site can be hosted on a normal desktop PC—provided you have a good Internet connection and a decent UPS

The first thing you need to look at is your Internet connection. There's no point hosting a site if your 'broadband' connection is one of those limited MB or GB connections. Web sites can consume a lot of bandwidth, especially your upload bandwidth, and since many ISPs count both the upload and download usage towards your billing, hosting your own site might not be a wise decision.

If you have an always-on connection, remember that not all ISPs provide you with a 1:1 ratio of upload to download bandwidth. So even if you have a 256 Kbps connection, it might be limited to 128 Kbps or less for upload speeds.

Even for a very small site, say, one that gets only a couple of visitors at a time, an upload of 128 Kbps is bare minimum. So make sure your connection meets this very basic requirement before you think of hosting your own site.

In terms of hardware, it is advisable to first see what you have lying about. In order to start a Web server, you will need a fully functional computer, with or without a monitor. Depending on the OS you select to run the server on, your requirements will vary.